



Table of Contents

Macher Jhol	1
Simple Aloor Dom	3
Mutton Kosha (bengali style)	5
Chicken Biryani	7
Grilled Cheese Sandwich	9
Chicken Sandwich	10
Radhaballavi	12
Egg Roll	14

Macher Jhol

Bengalis make various kinds of fish curry with different types of fishes. The most simple and easy one is 'macher jhol' or fish curry. 'Jhol' means runny version of a curry. This dish is usually served as lunch with steamed rice and we all are fan of it. In 'macher jhol' you can use rohu / katla / tilapia / pomfret / pabda etc. One can add many kinds of vegetables like potato, cauliflower, eggplant, green peas, carrot etc. I always make this dish with potato and cauliflower because of 'him'. He typically loves this combo. According to me, there is only one restriction about this dish. You have to use 'green chilies' only for the heat and flavour. Try not to use red chili powder or dry red chili because it will make a huge difference. So, here is the recipe how I make 'macher jhol' for my family.



Ingredients

4 fish pieces.
4 pieces of potato.
4-5 pieces of cauliflower.
Half onion thinly sliced.
Half tomato chopped.
1 Tablespoon nigella seeds (kalojeera).
5 green chilies.
2 Teaspoons turmeric powder.
Half Teaspoons roasted cumin powder.
Salt and sugar.
Half cup of mustard oil.
Warm water.

Steps

Wash the fish pieces very well and then marinate them with some salt and 1 Teaspoon turmeric powder for 15 minutes.
Heat oil in a kadai or pan. Fry the vegetables for 5 minutes in hot oil. Remove them in a plate.
Then add the marinated fish pieces one by one in hot oil.
Fry both side of them for 5 minutes. Then remove it from the pan. You can also keep them on a paper towel, it will absorb the extra oil. While frying the vegetables do not make them dark in color.
In the same hot oil add nigella seeds and 2

green chilies. Saute them. If you prefer to cook in less oil then remove some oil from the pan. But do not change the oil otherwise the taste will differ.

After a minute add sliced onion and pinch of salt. Fry them for 4 minutes in medium flame.

Do not make the onion dark in color.

Then add chopped tomato, pinch of salt, 1 Teaspoon turmeric powder, 1 Teaspoon cumin powder and half Teaspoon sugar. Mix it very well in low flame for 5 minutes.

When the oil starts separating add some warm water and 3 green chilies. Mix it well. If you like more heat, you can add more green chilies. Try to avoid red chili powder or dry red chili for this recipe only.

After 2 minutes add the fried vegetables. Cook this for 8 minutes.

Then add the fried fish pieces. Mix gently with spatula and cook it for another 5 minutes.

Check the seasoning and if you want more curry add some warm water.

Turn off the heat and rest it for 5 minutes.

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Simple Aloor Dom

Bengalis are always very fond of 'peas kochuri' and 'aloor dom' (Dum Aloo) during winter. In Texas, the temperature starts falling as we approach towards the winter time. I already took out light blankets, full sleeves and light sweaters. Last weekend 'he' begged me for 'kochuri-alurdom' and here is the result ... I have already posted one recipe of 'aloor dom' which we can make for party or any special occasions. But this one, you can eat anyday with 'luchi', 'paratha', 'daalpuri' and very easy to make. Try this in your kitchen and don't forget to share your winter story with us.



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Ingredients

10 baby potatoes.
1 cup onion slices.
1 inch ginger.
2 big cloves of garlic.
Half cup chopped tomato.
1 Teaspoon cumin seeds.
1 bay leaf.
1 dry red chili.
Spice powder (2 Teaspoons turmeric powder,
1 Teaspoon red chili powder, 2 Teaspoons
garam masala powder).
2 green chilies.
7 tablespoons of mustard oil.
Salt and sugar.
Warm water.

Steps

Peel the skin and wash the potatoes properly. Make a smooth paste of onion, ginger, garlic and tomato with little water. Keep it aside. Heat 3 tbsps of oil in a pan. Add potatoes, 1/2 Teaspoon salt and 1 Teaspoon turmeric powder. Mix it and fry it for 5 minutes. Remove them from the pan and heat remaining oil. Add cumin seeds, bay leaf and dry red chili in hot oil. Saute it for a minute. Then add the smooth paste. Cook it for 10 minutes. Then add spice powder, salt and pinch of sugar. Mix and cook it for another 5 minutes. Add the fried potatoes and green chilies. Mix

those very well.

Add some warm water. Cook it for 20 minutes.

When the potatoes become tender then turn off your heat.

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Mutton Kosha (bengali style)

I love to eat mutton in any preparation, but do you have any experience of "mutton kosha"? I would love to know your story. Because this dish is one of the traditional Bengali curries. We slow cook the mutton in its own juices with gravy and spices, that's why the end result always becomes finger licking good. You can serve 'mutton kosha' along with 'steamed rice', 'mishti pulao', 'luchi', 'porota' and 'plain roti'. Believe me every combo will make your lunch or dinner special everytime. Try this in your own kitchen and make your family happy.



Ingredients

Mutton 12-15 pieces.
Potato 4 pieces.
1 big onion chopped.
Ginger and garlic paste 2 Teaspoons.
1 small tomato chopped.
Turmeric powder 2 Teaspoon.
Red chili powder 1 Teaspoon.
Coriander powder 2 Teaspoon.
Cumin powder 1 Teaspoon.
Mace 1 blade.
Nutmeg powder half Teaspoon.
Whole spices (5 green cardamoms, 4 cloves,
1 dry red chilli, 1 small cinnamon stick, 1 bay
leaf)
1 Teaspoon garam masala powder.
4 green chilies.
Mustard oil 6 Teaspoon.

Salt and sugar.

Warm water.

Steps

Heat mustard oil in a kadai / pan.
Add 1 Teaspoon sugar in the hot oil and
caramelize it.
Then add bay leaf, green cardamom, cloves,
cinnamon stick and dry red chilli. Saute it for a
minute.
Add chopped onion with pinch of salt. Fry this
till golden brown.
Add ginger and garlic paste. Cook this for 2
minutes.
Then add chopped tomatoes. Cook this for 5
minutes.
Now add salt, all the above mentioned
powders and one blade of mace. Mix it for 3
minutes.

When the oil starts separating, add the mutton and enough salt. Mix it very well for 15 minutes.

Then cook it in slow flame with lid for 20 minutes. Mutton will leave its own juice.

If the mutton becomes too dry, then add some warm water.

After 35 minutes add the potatoes and green chilies.

Cook it till the meat AND potatoes become very soft. It will take time. Only if you have less time to cook, you can use pressure cooker.

Mutton should have some very thick gravy (usually its a semi-dry preparation).

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Chicken Biryani

I do have someone in my home who wants to eat my handmade 'chicken biriyani' once in a week. I make this biriyani not too much rich and spicy but with some mild flavours and tender chicken pieces. I do not like any side with my biriyani because I only want to enjoy those flavours of biriyani. For him I make 'korma'/'chaaap'/'kosha' etc. Enjoy your weekend with a full plate of homemade warm Biryani.



Ingredients

Chicken leg pieces 4.
Basmati rice 4 cups.
Two small potatoes.
One onion sliced.
Ginger and garlic paste 2 Teaspoon.
Curd 4 Teaspoon.
Biryani masala 4 Teaspoon.(from any indian store).
Cumin seed 1 Teaspoon.
Green cardamom 5.
Six cloves.
One star anis.
One small cinnamon stick.
Yellow food colour.
Two green chilies.
Clarified butter/ghee 8 Teaspoons.
2 Teaspoons kewra water.
Salt and sugar.
Water.

Steps

Marinate the chicken pieces with curd, ginger and garlic paste for 3 hours.
Take a pan. Heat 4 Teaspoons ghee.
Add sliced onion. Fry it till golden brown.
Add marinated chicken. Mix it well.
Add salt, biryani masala, green chilies and potato. Mix it very well for 5 minutes.
Now add some luke warm water and cook this until potatoes and chicken are fully done.
Don't make it too much runny or dry. Make some thick gravy .
Turn off the gas.
Now wash the basmati rice in cold water very well.
Boil some water with cumin seeds, green cardamom, cloves, cinnamon stick, star anis and 4 Teaspoons salt.
Add the rice in boiling water. Check the rice every two minutes.
When the rice 80% done drain the water.
Now take vessel. Don't turn on the gas. Put 1

Teaspoon ghee.

Then put a layer of cooked chicken with some gravy, then a layer of rice. Repeat the process twice. Add 3 Teaspoons ghee, 2 Teaspoons of kewra water and a pinch of yellow food color on top of rice.

Cover the vessel with a very tight lid. Turn on the gas and keep the vessel on gas for 20 minutes in medium flame.

Then turn off the gas and keep it uncover for another 10 minutes. After that open the vessel.

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Grilled Cheese Sandwich

Sandwich without cheese? - boring Cheesy gooey sandwich? - total fun Yes I am talking about grilled cheese sandwich. This one is the most easy sandwich recipe in the world. The choice of cheese is entirely upto you. You can serve this as breakfast and also as evening snack. Your little tummy will enjoy this sandwich everytime. Here, I have done something new. I have posted step by step clicks along with the recipe, so that the process become more lucid for you. Grab a sandwich and enjoy an evening with your loved ones.



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Ingredients

- 4 slices of bread.
- 2 Teaspoons of soft butter.
- 8 Teaspoons of shredded cheese.

Steps

- Spread 1/2 Teaspoon butter on one side of a bread.
- Put the butter side of the bread down.
- Place the shredded cheese on the other side of the bread.
- Spread 1/2 Teaspoon butter on another bread.
- Keep that butter side of the bread outside and put it on the cheese.
- Place the sandwich on hot pan. Keep it for 2 minutes.
- Turn it to the other side and keep it for another 2 minutes. The cheese will melt properly.

Then remove it from the pan, cut it to halves and serve.

Chicken Sandwich

Who doesn't love sandwich ? When there is chicken, I am always up for it . I make this kind of sandwich in my home oftenly. The taste is kind of Indian spicy but believe me you will love it. One can make many kinds of sandwiches, and this one is my kind. If you have everything in your hand then the process is very simple and easy. You will need 'green chutney' for the sandwich. Make this in your own kitchen and don't forget to share your sandwich story with me.



Ingredients

For Chicken

- 1 chicken breast.
- 1 Teaspoon black pepper.
- Half Teaspoon red chili powder.
- 1 Teaspoon lemon juice.
- 1 Teaspoon ginger and garlic paste.
- Some bread crumbs.
- Salt.
- 5 tablespoons white oil.

For Sandwich

- 4 slices of white bread.
- 4 Teaspoons butter.
- 4 Teaspoons green chutney.
- 4 Teaspoons mayonnaise.
- 5 Teaspoons chili sauce.
- Half cup onion thinly sliced.
- Half cup capsicum thinly sliced.
- 4 tablespoons grated cheese.

Steps

For chicken

Marinate the chicken breast with black pepper, chili powder, salt, lemon juice, ginger and garlic paste. Keep it for 30 minutes.

Then heat oil in a pan.

Coat the chicken breast with marination in bread crumbs and place it in hot oil.

Fry one side in medium flame for 15 minutes then turn it to the other side and cook it for another 10 minutes. Remove it from the oil.

Let it cool down a bit and then slice the breast with a sharp knife.

Assembling

Mix the mayonnaise and chilli sauce in bowl. Keep it aside.

Spread 1 Teaspoon butter on outer side of a bread which will go at the bottom.

Then spread 1 Teaspoon green chutney on

inner side of that bread.

Place some chicken slices, onions, capsicum and 2 tablespoons of cheese on that bread.

Spread 1 Teaspoon mayo mixture on the inner side of a bread which will go to the top.

Then spread 1 Teaspoon butter on outer side of that bread.

Sandwich

Place the sandwich in a hot pan. Remember, place the butter side of the bread down. Keep it for 2 minutes.

Then flip it carefully to the other side. Keep it another 2 minutes.

Remove it from the pan and cut it to half.

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Radhaballavi

Almost in every Bengali wedding they serve 'radhaballavi' along with 'aloor dom' as breakfast. 'Radhaballavi' is nothing but deep fried puffed bread stuffed with spicy lentil. It tastes even better with spicy curry and 'rosogolla'. There are many varieties of fried puffed bread like 'daalpuri', 'luchi', 'kochuri' etc and this one is also very tasty. Last night I made it along with potato curry and we all love it.



Ingredients

For stuffing

- 1 cup of urad daal / biuli daal.
- 1 inch ginger.
- 1 green chilli.
- 1 Teaspoon asafoetida / hing.
- Spices (1 Teaspoon cumin seeds, 1 Teaspoon fennel seeds, 2 dry red chilies)
- Salt and sugar.
- 3 tablespoons of white oil.

For dough

- 2 cups of all purpose flour.
- Salt.
- 2 Teaspoons of white oil.
- Some warm water.
- White oil for deep frying.

Steps

Stuffing

Wash and soak the daal for 3-4 hours.

Then drain the water and grind it along with ginger and green chili to a semi smooth paste. You can add little water while grinding. Keep aside.

Dry roast the spices for 5 minutes and grind them to fine powder. Keep it aside.

Heat 3 tbsps white oil in a pan.

Add asafoetida in hot oil. Mix it for 30 secs. Then add the mixture of daal. Keep stirring it for 15 minutes.

Add salt, pinch of sugar and that spice powder. Mix it very well for another 7 minutes. Turn off the heat and let it cool down.

Dough

Take flour, salt and oil in a bowl. Mix these dry things very well.

Then add little by little water and keep mixing with the flour. Make a semi soft dough.

Knead it properly for 6 minutes. Apply some oil

on the surface and let it rest covered with damp cloth for 20 minutes.

Frying

First make lemon size balls out of the dough and then make small size balls out of the stuffing.

Now take a dough ball, flatten it, put a stuffing ball in the center and then seal the edges.

Apply some oil on the surface and flatten it gently to 2-3 inches with a rolling pin otherwise the stuffing will come out.

Fry this bread in hot oil one by one. When it will puff up and golden in color, remove them in a paper towel.

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Egg Roll

One of the famous street food from Kolkata is 'egg roll'. A flaky paratha, a layer of egg and lots of veggies with sauces will never fail to satisfy your appetite. There are so many varieties of roll like 'egg-chicken roll', 'mutton roll', 'paneer roll', 'egg-mutton roll' etc. They all are very yummy and easy to make. Try this in your kitchen and let me know about your story.



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Ingredients

For paratha

2 cups of all purpose flour.

2 Teaspoons white oil.

4 Teaspoons curd or yogurt.

Salt.

Warm water.

For layering and filling

3 eggs.

Salt.

1 cup cucumber thinly sliced.

1 cup onion thinly sliced.

3 green chilies chopped.

3 tablespoons green chutney.

3 tablespoons chili sauce.

3 Teaspoons tomato ketchup.

Steps

Put flour, little salt, oil and curd in a bowl. Mix it with your hand very well for 2 minutes. Then add little by little warm water and mix it. Make a semi soft dough. Knead the dough for

4 minutes and cover with a damp cloth for 15 minutes.

Now take a small portion in your palm. Shape it like a ball. Dip it in the flour and flatten it to 3-4 inch with rolling pin.

Heat a tawa / frying pan for 2 minutes.

Place the paratha in the hot tawa for 2 minutes.

Turn the side and give it another 2 minutes.

Remove it from the pan. You will need half-cooked paratha.

Frying

Now heat 3 tablespoons of white oil in a pan. Beat a egg with pinch of salt and add in the hot oil. Immediately place the half cooked paratha on the egg because it will stick to the egg.

After 3 minutes of frying turn it to the other side and give it another 3 minutes. After that remove it from the pan.

I mentioned 3 eggs because you can make 3

rolls out of the ingredients.

Assembling

Now as a filling first spread 1 table spoon green chutney, then some cucumber and onion slices, some green chilies and lastly add 2 sauces.

Roll the paratha and secure one side with paper towel (take a look at the picture).

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